
3D Level Planning

Shi Heng Teng - The Tower Castle Beyond the Maze

Synopsis / Theme

Game Name: The Tower Castle Beyond the Maze

Theme: Exploration, Mystery, Nature

Synopsis: Isle of Whispers is a mysterious island long rumored to hold a hidden treasure sealed within the tower castle at its heart. The tower castle, however, is concealed deep within a sprawling maze. To reach it, the player must navigate through the overgrown labyrinth and activate ancient beacons hidden within smaller area scattered across the maze. Only by unlocking all the beacons can the final seal on the great tower castle be broken, revealing the path to the treasure above.

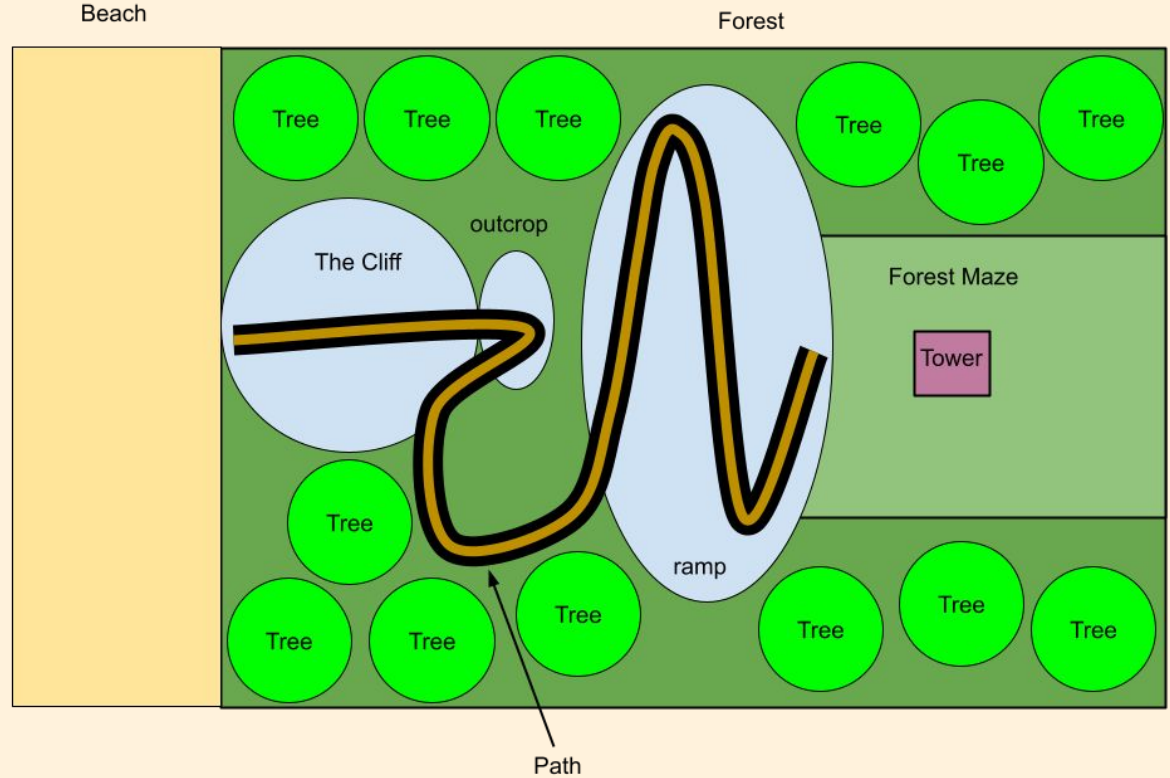


Level Layout

Whole Level Layout

Spatial Archetypes Used

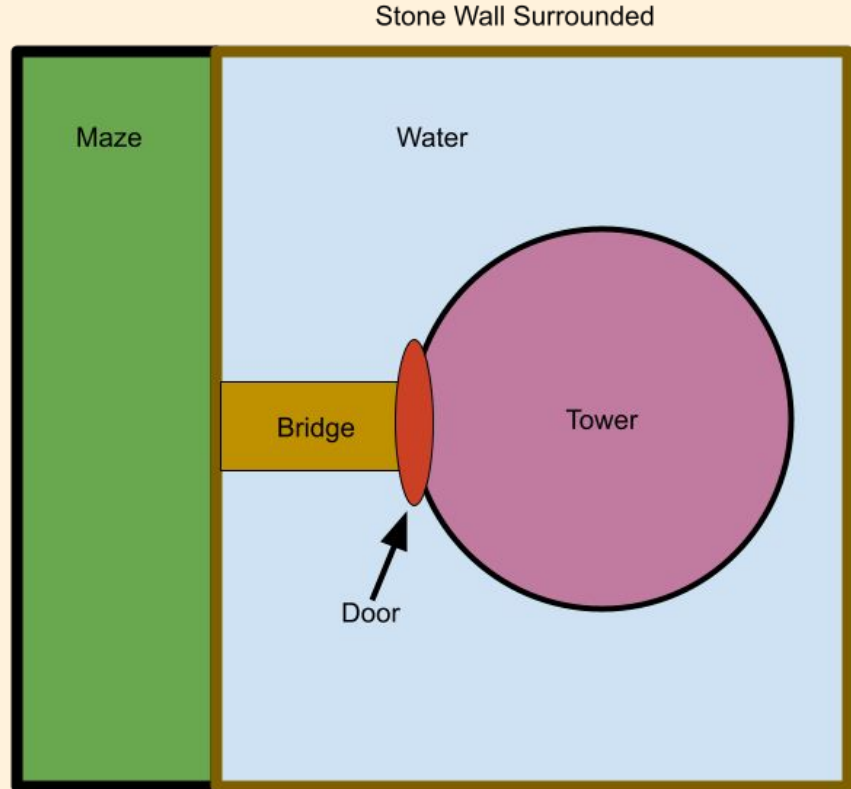
- The Plain (Openness)
 - The beach
- The Pillar (Goals / Landmark)
 - The tower castle
- The Cliff (Barrier)
- The Outcrop (Vision to the tower and the maze)
- The Path (Guide)
- The Ramp (Anticipation)
- The Maze (Secrets)



Whole Level Layout (Zoomed into the tower castle at the center of the maze)

Spatial Archetypes Used

- The Bridge (Connection)
- The Wall (Protection)
- The Door (Threshold)

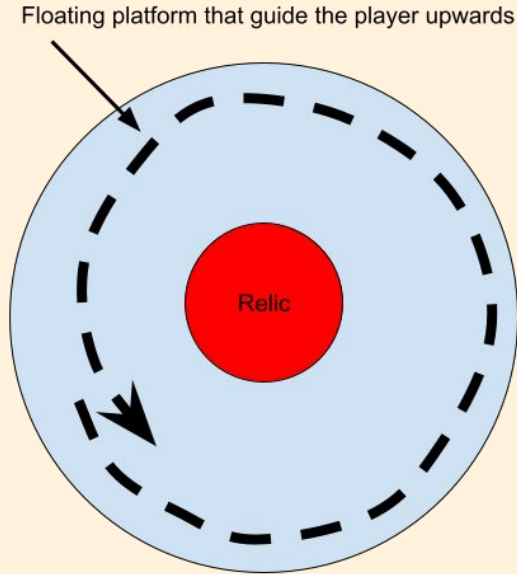


Whole Level Layout (Interior of the tower castle)

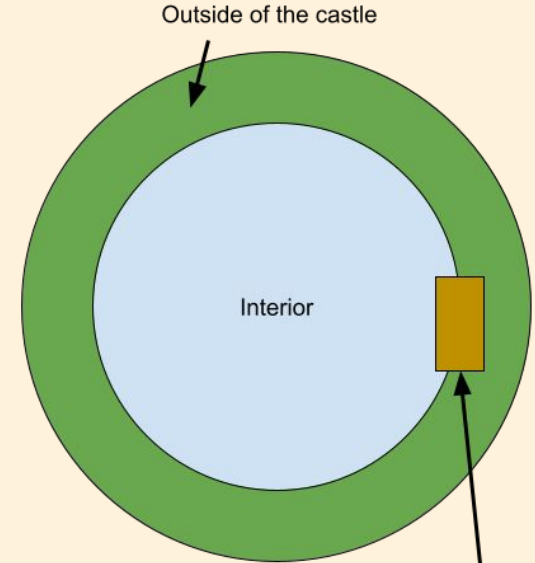
Spatial Archetypes Used

- The Ramp (Anticipation)
 - The floating platform
- The Door (Threshold)

Castle Floor Map



Lowest Level

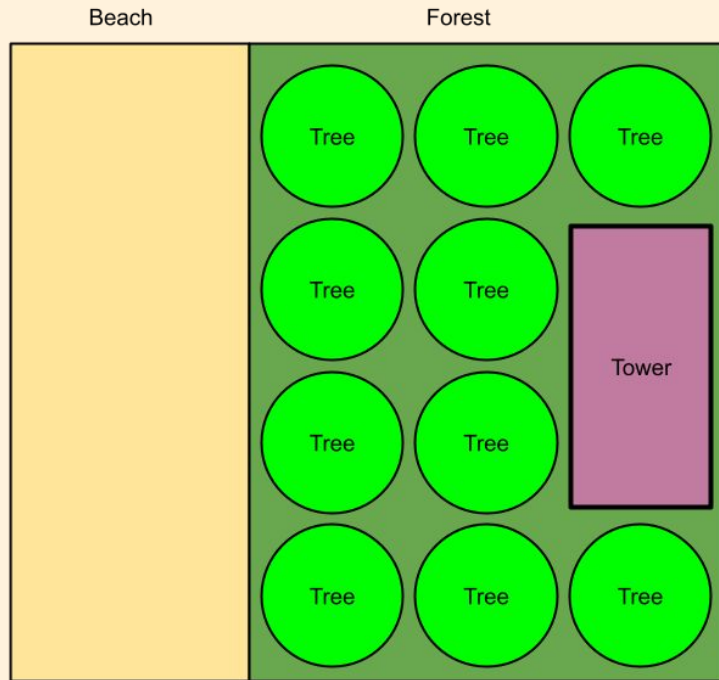


Highest Level

Door

Setup

- Arrive at the mysterious Isle of Whispers.
- Legend speaks of a treasure hidden in a tower castle at the island's center.
- You dock at a desolate beach with only a map and view of a distant tower castle.



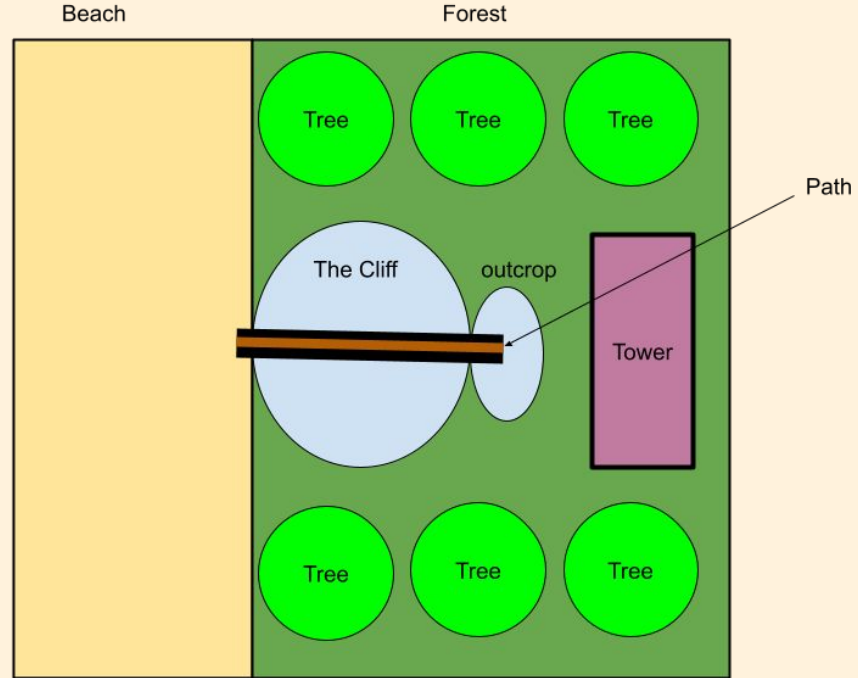
Mood Board



Able to see the tall tower castle from afar

Hook

- You notice a natural path leads you from the beach into the dense forest that seemingly brings you nearer to the tower castle.
- The trail feels long-forgotten — overgrowth blankets the ground, and broken tree trunks obstruct your steps.
- You push through tangled brush and damp earth.
- After a weary trek, the forest parts — revealing a cliffside outcrop ahead.



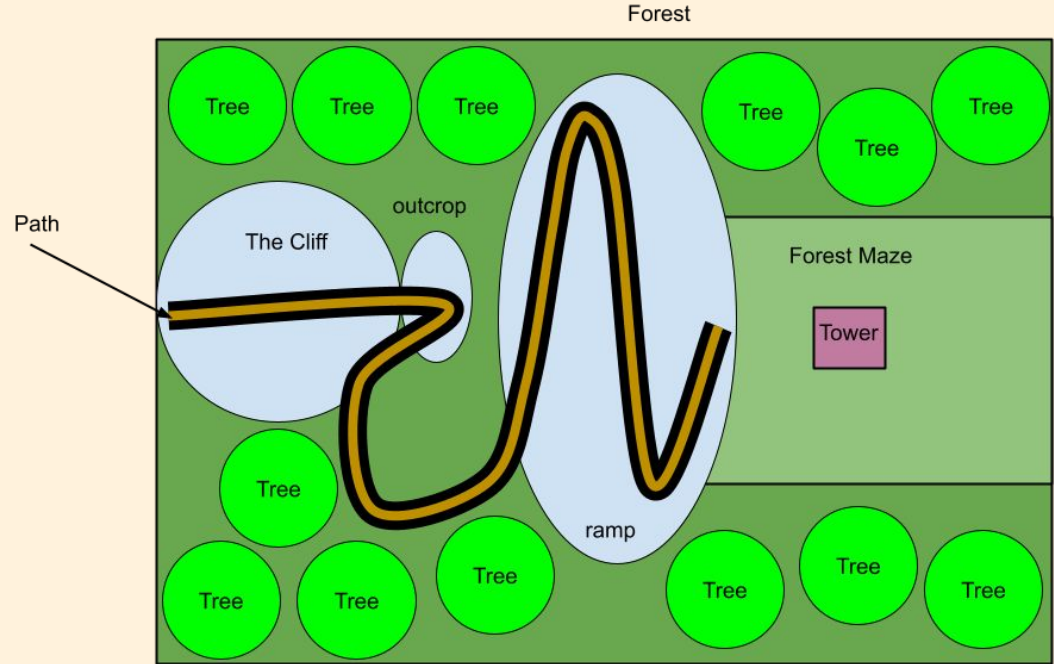
Mood Board



The entrance into the forest, leading you nearer to the tower castle

Development 1

- Reach the cliffside outcrop with a stunning view.
- Below: a vast grass maze with a sealed central spire, also spotted three suspicious spots that is hidden in the maze
- A descending ramp leads to the maze entrance.
- You also notice a stone marker says: Activate 3 ancient beacons to unlock the tower castle.



Mood Board



Players standing at the outcrop of the cliff



What the player Sees

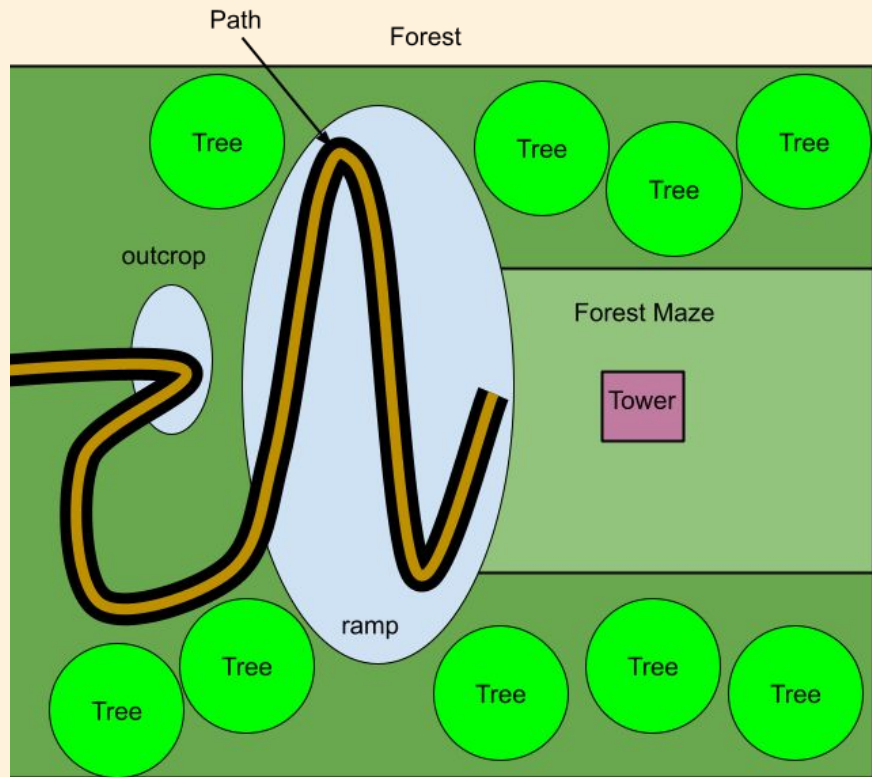
Mood Board



Walking down guided path down the ramp

Development 2

- You begin descending the ramp
- Light dims as fog thickens
- the sky turns a dull gray.
- Distant caws of crows echo through the trees.
- The forest shifts: dead trees, twisted roots
- At the ramp's end, the massive forest maze rises ahead — tall walls of overgrowth and stone, looming in silence.



Mood Board



Starts to get dark and eerie as the player walks down the guided path ramp to the entrance of the maze



The fog at the maze entrance giving the maze a bit of mysterious vibes



A stone tablet to tell them to solve 3 puzzles at the entry of the maze.

Development 3

- Inside the maze, as you navigate through maze you will find 3 beacon area,
- The beacon in that area will light up once the pressure plate in the region has been stepped
- First Beacon:
 - A dragon statue at the center of of the open-spaced area
 - A button to step on is in front of the dragon statues
- Second Beacon:
 - Filled with fallen warrior statues, and twisting tree branches.
 - Need to spot for 2 hidden pressure plates to stepped on
- Third Beacon:
 - A king statue standing in the center of the area, surrounded with many swords
 - Need to find the 3 pressure plates to step
 - On activation, a deep resonant tone echoes and last pulse of light shoots upwards — the final seal breaks.

Colour Legend:

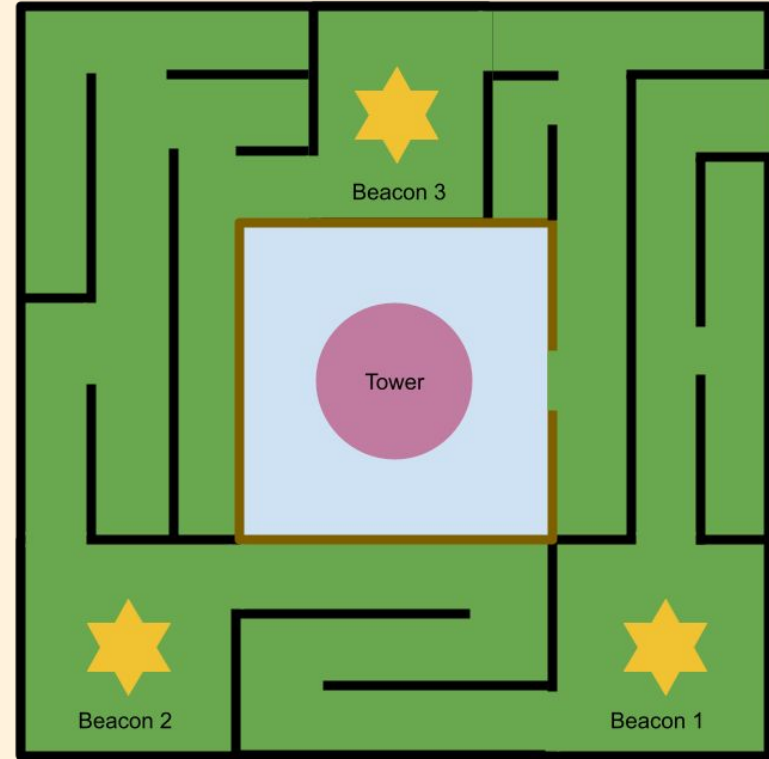
Leaf Bushes



Stone Wall



Water



Mood Board (Puzzle)

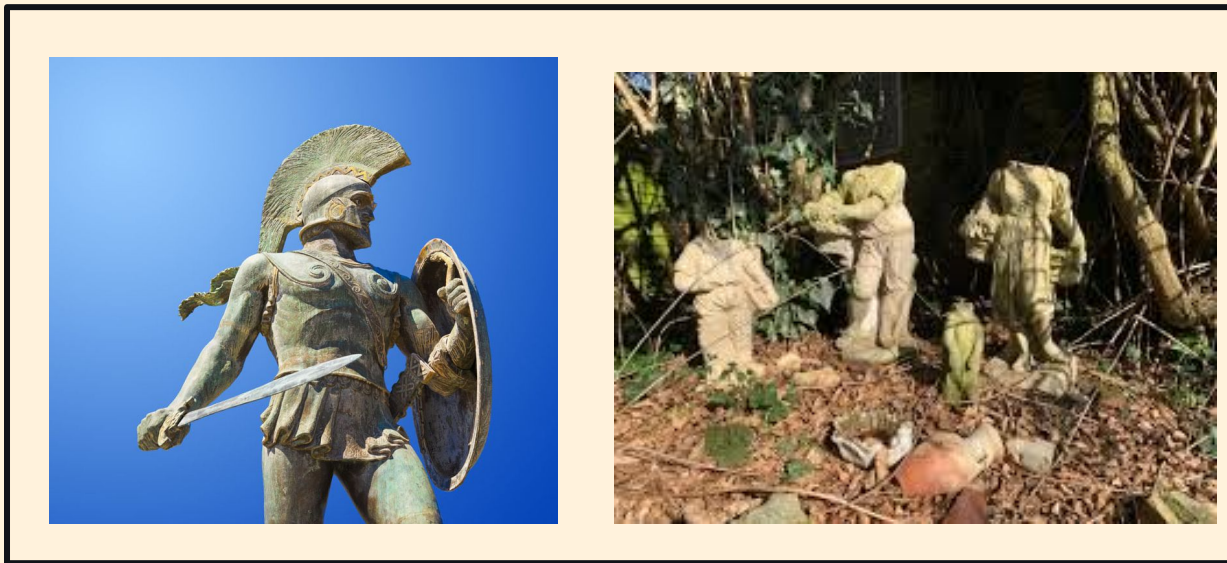


Dragon Statue at the center of the beacon area 1



Stepping on the pressure plate

Mood Board (Beacon 2 Surrounding)



Undamaged warrior statues surrounded with many broken statues

Mood Board (Beacon 3 Surrounding)



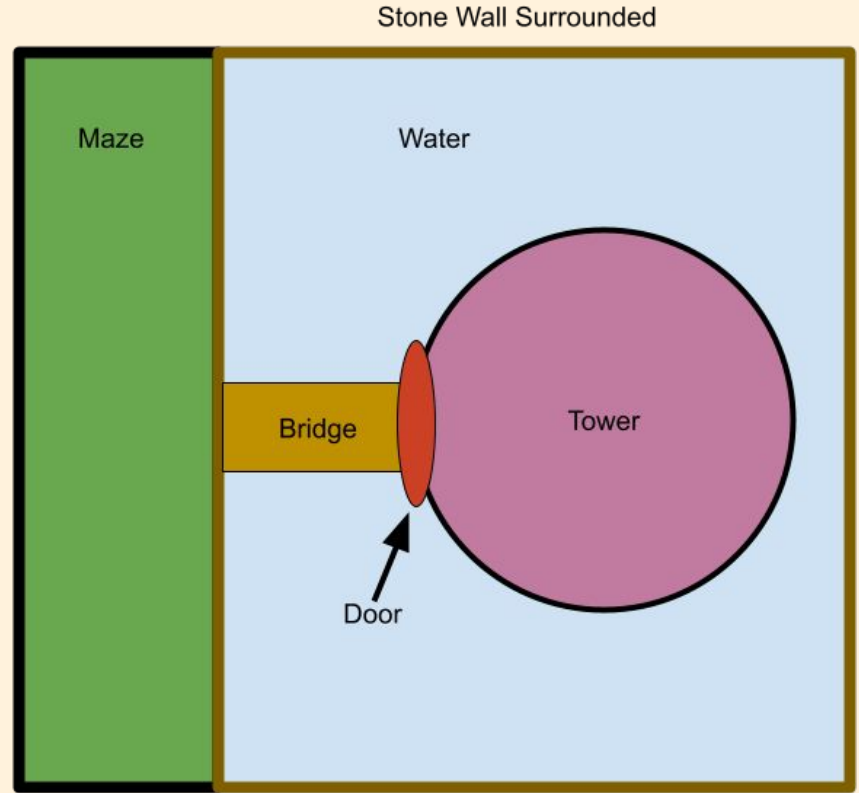
Guards scattering in the area



The king statue holding a sword with missing red gem

Turn

- Reaching the center of the maze, you're met with a blocked access to the tower castle.
- Nearby, a flashing switch catches your eye — you press it.
- With a low rumble, a stone bridge begins laying itself down, connecting you to the tower castle.
- As you walk across, the tower castle doors slowly open, revealing a dim, mysterious interior.
- At its heart, atop a pedestal, rests the shimmering relic — the treasure you've been seeking.



Mood Board



The bridge connecting the maze and the tower castle

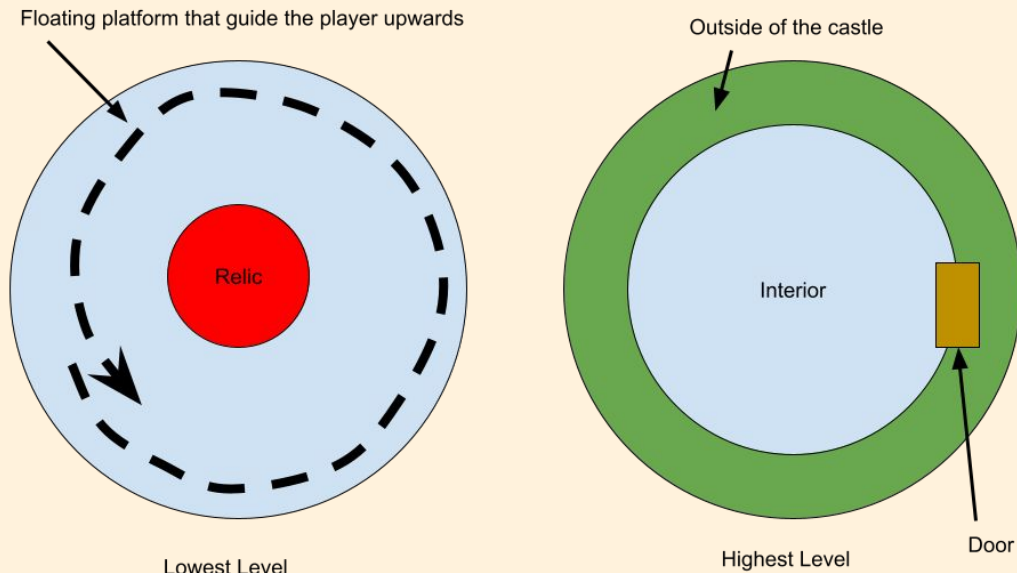


The top-down view of the castle surrounded by water

Resolution

- After claiming the relic, the floating platforms begin to rise, bringing you to the upper level of the tower
- At the upper level of the tower, you begin your climbing up the spiral staircase.
- At last, you push open a final heavy door.
- You step out onto the summit of the tower castle.
- You saw the breathtaking view:
 - The entire island stretches out below you.
 - You see the path you took, the maze, and the glowing beacons — now quiet and still.
- Game Ends

Castle Floor Map



Mood Board (Castle Interior)



The Castle Interior (with the center being placed with relic on top of a pedestal)



The treasure relic that is placed at the center for the player to pick up

Mood Board (Castle Interior)



The platform that will send player upwards
once they pick up the treasure relic



The spiral staircase to bring the player
upwards to the top of the tower

Mood Board (The Summit View) - End of the Game

